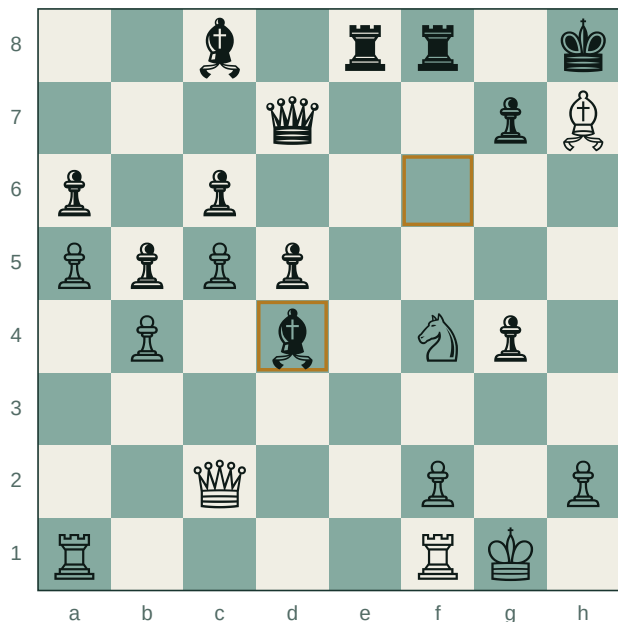


Double checks: White, move 22

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 21...Bxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22. Ng6+ Kxh7 23. Nxf8+ Kg8 24. Nxd7

22.Ng6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g6 it attacks king on h8 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **22...Kxh7**.

23.Nxf8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From f8 it attacks king on h7 and queen on d7. Recorded reply: **23...Kg8**.

24.Nxd7 The knight captures the queen on d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +11. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +11:** the balance goes from -1 to +10. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d4. Check for tactical protection.